

The wax gives under your thumb — a seal none of you knows. Inside: a single sheet of instructions, and folded beneath it, heavier, the thing itself — the letter you are paid to carry, and forbidden to read.

Outside, the city does not yet know to be afraid. It is Saint Dorothy's day, the last gasp of carnival before the fast — pipes and drums down every street, masks on half the faces you pass, a child pressing paper roses into your hands as if roses grew in February. Good cover, a day like this: you can wear another face, and no one looks at you twice.

Toruń, the 6th of February, the Year of Our Lord 1454

MESSENGERS,

The sealed letter enclosed with this note is not yours to read. Carry it.
Protect it. Deliver it before the eighth bell strikes tonight.

You were paid to do a simple thing. The city has made it complicated. Your contact is not where he was meant to be, and you will have to find your own way to the one who must receive this.

Know this: whoever reads that letter, loses it, or puts it in the wrong hands will answer for it. Not with coin. WITH THEIR HANDS. You are warned once. You will not be warned again.

YOUR ROAD BEGINS HERE.

Enclosed: a MAP of marks and a CIPHER SHEET.

Each mark on the map tells you only *where* to go — never what you will find.
That you must see for yourselves.

BEGIN AT Δ . Find it on the map and go.

At each mark:

1. Look for a **DETAIL** that matches one of the pictures on your cipher sheet.
2. That picture points you to the **NEXT MARK**. Go there. Do it again.
3. Write each place you name into the **LEGEND** on your map.

Your chain is **EXACTLY FOUR STEPS** long, and it ends where you are to make contact.

Beware false trails: if you find yourselves going in circles, or returning to a mark you have already named, you have strayed – go back to the last mark you were sure of.

↪ **GAME MASTER** – When your chain is complete, bring your **FOUR PLACES**, **IN THE ORDER YOU FOUND THEM**, to the Game Master. That is your way onward.

Tell no one.

So: a letter you cannot read, a road you must find for yourselves, and a plain promise of what failure costs. Whoever wants this carried does not mean for you to enjoy the carrying. The first mark is waiting on the map. You start walking.